

White Ranger

The MGU's mythic film. It plays the role *Thor* played for Marvel: a warrior who loses his power, proves he's worthy, and is reborn stronger.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, April 22, 2016
Distributor	20th Century Fox
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 155 minutes
Real title	White Ranger
Decoy title	Paper Tiger
Whose film it is	The White Ranger, Tommy Oliver. The film launches the White Ranger line.

WHY THIS CHARACTER AND THIS DATE

The White Ranger fills the Thor role.

- **Thor's arc is the White Ranger's arc in canon.** A proud warrior is stripped of his power (Zedd drains Tommy's Green powers for good) and has to fight without it. A father figure (Zordon, our Odin) judges him worthy and gives him a new power, the White Ranger, along with Saba. Lord Zedd fills the Loki role.
- **It's a new identity, not a repeat.** The White Ranger is the most iconic power-up in the franchise, a new mantle and a new mythology, and it makes Tommy the team's leader.
- **The date:** it opens in spring like *Thor*, two weeks ahead of *Captain America: Civil War*, and away from Fox's own *Deadpool* (February) and *X-Men: Apocalypse* (May 27).

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

White Ranger, shot as Paper Tiger

- **Real title:** *White Ranger*.
- **Decoy title:** *Paper Tiger*, an old phrase for something that looks strong and turns out empty. It quietly hides the White Tigerzord and doesn't hint at Power Rangers.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

The White Ranger, Tommy Oliver

- It's Tommy's fall and rebirth.
- **Faithfulness lock:** Jason, Zack, Billy, Trini and Kimberly are all in it at full strength. In canon, Jason accepts Tommy as the new leader, and that scene is played as respect, not as Jason being pushed aside.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year Two: summer 2014

- **When:** summer 2014, after the events of *Blue Ranger*, even though *Blue Ranger* is released later. That's the same release-order switch as *Thor* and *The First Avenger*.
- **Where:** Angel Grove, the Command Center and its hidden chamber, and Lord Zedd's Moon palace.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

Worthy

- Lord Zedd sets out to destroy the Green Ranger for good, and succeeds: **Tommy's Green powers are drained permanently**, as in canon. The Dragonzord goes back to the sea.
- Powerless, Tommy still fights. He protects Angel Grove unmorphed as the martial artist he is, even though he can't win. Meanwhile Zedd's monsters and Z Putties push the team to the edge.
- Then a **mysterious White Ranger** appears and saves the team. No one knows who it is, not the Rangers and not Zedd.
- **The reveal:** it's Tommy. Zordon and Alpha 5 created the White Ranger power, and Zordon chose Tommy as worthy of it. That power includes **Saba**, the talking saber, and the **White Tigerzord**.
- **Ending:** Zordon names the White Ranger the new leader of the Power Rangers. Jason is the first to step aside and back him.

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

Lord Zedd, Emperor of All He Sees

- **Lord Zedd** at full canon power: he turns ordinary objects into monsters with his Z-Staff and commands an army. He's the Loki-role villain who carries into the team film.
- His forces: Goldar, who now serves Zedd; Finster; Squatt and Baboo; and the **Z Putties**, which shatter when struck on the Z on their chest.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

Two scenes

- **Mid-credits: "The Dumpster."** Out in space, Rita's dumpster drifts, and from inside, a muffled laugh. She isn't finished.
- **End-credits: "The Serpent."** In a hangar on the Moon, Zedd stands in front of something huge in the shadows: **Serpentera**, his own war machine. "Not yet," he tells Goldar.

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

Draining power

- Zedd draining a Ranger's power for good establishes, on screen, that a villain can drain a being of the Grid's power. That's the same thing Dark Specter does to Zordon at the end of the saga.
- Zordon creates a new power from his own resources, which shows how much the Rangers depend on him and makes his eventual capture more devastating.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

The White Ranger mythos

- The White Ranger power, Saba, the White Tigerzord, and the secret chamber where Zordon forges new powers.
- Tommy's journey from rival to villain to ally to leader.

09 • MGU WORLD-BUILDING

The rules every later film builds on

- **New Ranger powers can be created.** That's the canon basis for the Zeo, Turbo and Astro powers later.
- **Leadership passes:** the Red Ranger isn't automatically the leader, and Zordon decides who is.
- **Zedd's army and Serpentera** are introduced as threats the MGU will return to.

10 • ITS ROLE IN PHASE 1

How it builds toward the team film

- It takes the MGU into its mythic side and gives the team film its villain, the way *Thor* gave *The Avengers* Loki. It also puts Tommy in place as the leader the team film needs.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Mighty Morphin Power Rangers series.